Kramer 1940 — *Lamentation over the Destruction of Ur* (Assyriological Studies 12)

- **Author:** Samuel Noah Kramer. Chicago: University of Chicago Press (Oriental Institute), 1940. xii + 97 pp., 4 plates.
- **URLs:** catalogue https://isac.uchicago.edu/node/3443 ; PDF https://isac-assets.s3.amazonaws.com/isac-publications/as12.pdf (the link on `isac.uchicago.edu/sites/default/files/uploads/shared/docs/as12.pdf` returns an HTML page pointing there).
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-19 (curl, browser User-Agent).
- **Licence:** © 1940 University of Chicago; distributed free by ISAC (the Institute for the Study of Ancient Cultures) for personal and scholarly use. Licence for redistribution not stated → **gitignored** (only this README is committed).

Files (local only)

- `as12.pdf` — the scanned volume (OCR layer).
- `as12.txt` — `pdftotext -layout` extraction (the OCR has errors in diacritics and sign indices; use for the translation and the commentary, never for the transliteration).

Content

Introduction (a summary of the eleven "songs", the historical setting, the manuscripts known in 1940); transliteration and translation of the composite on facing pages (pp. 16–71; Kramer's 436 lines, the same numbering as ETCSL); commentary.

Usefulness

Rank 5 (pre-1990): the first edition, historically important (the first full Sumerian city lament, and the first comparison with Lamentations). Readings are outdated in places (Kramer's "song" for *kirugu*; many Emesal forms misunderstood in 1940). Use as a literal check and for the history of interpretation only.